

ORQ8

The AI Organization Operating System an executive overview. Tell ORQ8 what you want. It hires the team, does the work, and reports back.

What is ORQ8?

ORQ8 is a platform that lets a human CEO build and run a real company staffed by AI employees. It is not a chatbot, not a task manager, and not an "agent zoo." It is an operating system for an organization: the CEO speaks naturally a vague idea, a question, a goal, a command and the system forms teams, hires agents, plans work, governs every action, and reports results.

The human CEO remains the final authority. Everything consequential requires approval, everything significant is audited, and every dollar is tracked.

The problem

Everyone is building AI agents; nobody is building the system that makes agents safe, governed, and accountable.

Gartner predicts over 40% of agentic AI projects will be canceled by 2027 due to cost control, unclear value, and missing risk controls, not model quality.

Solo founders and small operators have no middle management to delegate to; they drown in operations while agent tools add noise, not structure.

How it works the Golden Workflow

The core loop: Intent, Understand, Context, Plan, Deliberate, Recommend, Authorize, Execute, Verify, Report, Learn.

Example. The CEO says: "I think we should build an AI customer support product for African businesses. Find out whether this is worth pursuing." ORQ8: (1) classifies the intent; (2) convenes a temporary strategy council market researcher, finance analyst, legal researcher, growth strategist; (3) members research independently and challenge one another; (4) the Executive Agent synthesizes a recommendation with evidence, alternatives, confidence, and the approval required; (5) the CEO approves in the Decision Center; (6) a project is created, the workforce is simulated, and temporary agents are hired and onboarded; (7) agents execute using tools, requesting approvals, flagging blockers; (8) the organization learns, writes to Company Memory, and reports weekly. All of it every step, decision, and cost is audited.

What is inside

Governance in code, not prompts

Every organization has a Company Constitution: forbidden actions, approval tiers (Automatic, Department, Executive, CEO, Forbidden), spending authority, and escalation rules.

Consequential actions require server-side approval. Agents cannot bypass approval, elevate their own permissions, modify governance, or access secrets.

A tamper-evident, append-only audit trail records every significant action, approval, and cost.

Executive Agent & intent engine

Understands vague requests, gathers context, plans, delegates, convenes councils, and asks for human input only when it truly matters.

An AI workforce

Agents are hired with business cases, organized into departments, teams, temporary project teams, and councils with performance reviews, versioning, and knowledge transfer on replacement.

Money & budget control

Budget allocation is separate from spending authority; target, warning, and ceiling levels; per-agent spending limits; hiring budget kept apart from operating budget.

Every dollar of model and tool spend is attributed to a department, project, and agent.

Company memory & decision precedent

Persistent institutional knowledge. Agents must consult precedent before re-proposing an approach that was already rejected and explain what changed.

Model-agnostic and cost-aware

Routes every task to the cheapest adequate model. Runs on free local models today; Bring-Your-Own-Key for OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, DeepSeek, Groq, and OpenRouter.

Executive reporting

A CEO Decision Center instead of notification noise; weekly briefings and monthly executive reports prepared by a reporting agent and reviewed by the Executive Agent.

Why now the market

AI agents market: ~\$7.6B in 2025, projected ~\$183B by 2033 (Grand View Research, ~50% CAGR). Gartner projects ~\$202B of agentic AI spending in 2026.

The governance gap is the #1 complaint across agent deployments which is exactly what ORQ8 builds: the operating system layer everyone is missing.

The "one-person company powered by AI" wave is mainstream, and the category is producing multi-billion-dollar companies (Sierra \$10B, Cognition \$10B+, Decagon \$4.5B, Thinking Machines \$12B).

Business model

Free	1 organization, 3 agents, free/local models \$0
Pro	10 agents, BYOK, full governance, weekly report \$49/mo
Business	50 agents, audit, integrations, monthly report \$199/mo
Enterprise	Private deployment, SLA, custom integrations custom

Users pay for the platform (governance, orchestration, memory, reporting); model costs pass through via Bring-Your-Own-Key. Clean margins, no lock-in, free to start. ORQ8 runs no agent marketplace and takes no commissions revenue comes from the operating system itself: platform tiers, organizational capacity, enterprise capabilities, and optional AI/voice/infrastructure usage never from a cut of your workforce (ADR-021).

Status & next steps

Phase 0 complete: full product specification architecture, security model, database schema, API contracts, and go-to-market plan (58 documents + architecture decision records), all versioned and public.

Building Phase 1 (Foundation): monorepo, database, authentication, API shell on a free, self-hosted local stack.

Target: the Golden Workflow working end-to-end on free models, then design partners, paid beta, and general availability.